



MAIDEN FLIGHT

The Harrier "Jump Jet" made its first flight in 1966, three years after the first hovering flight made by its prototype, the Hawker P.1127 (shown here). The production Harrier went into full RAF service in 1969.

EYES FRONT

The "head-up" display unit featured in this Royal Navy Sea Harrier (right) shows vital flight information such as altitude and speed on its glass panel. This means that the pilot is able to take in this data without looking down.



Wraparound windshield

Control stick

Detonation cord (shatters canopy during emergency ejection)

Head-up display unit

Pilot in full flight gear

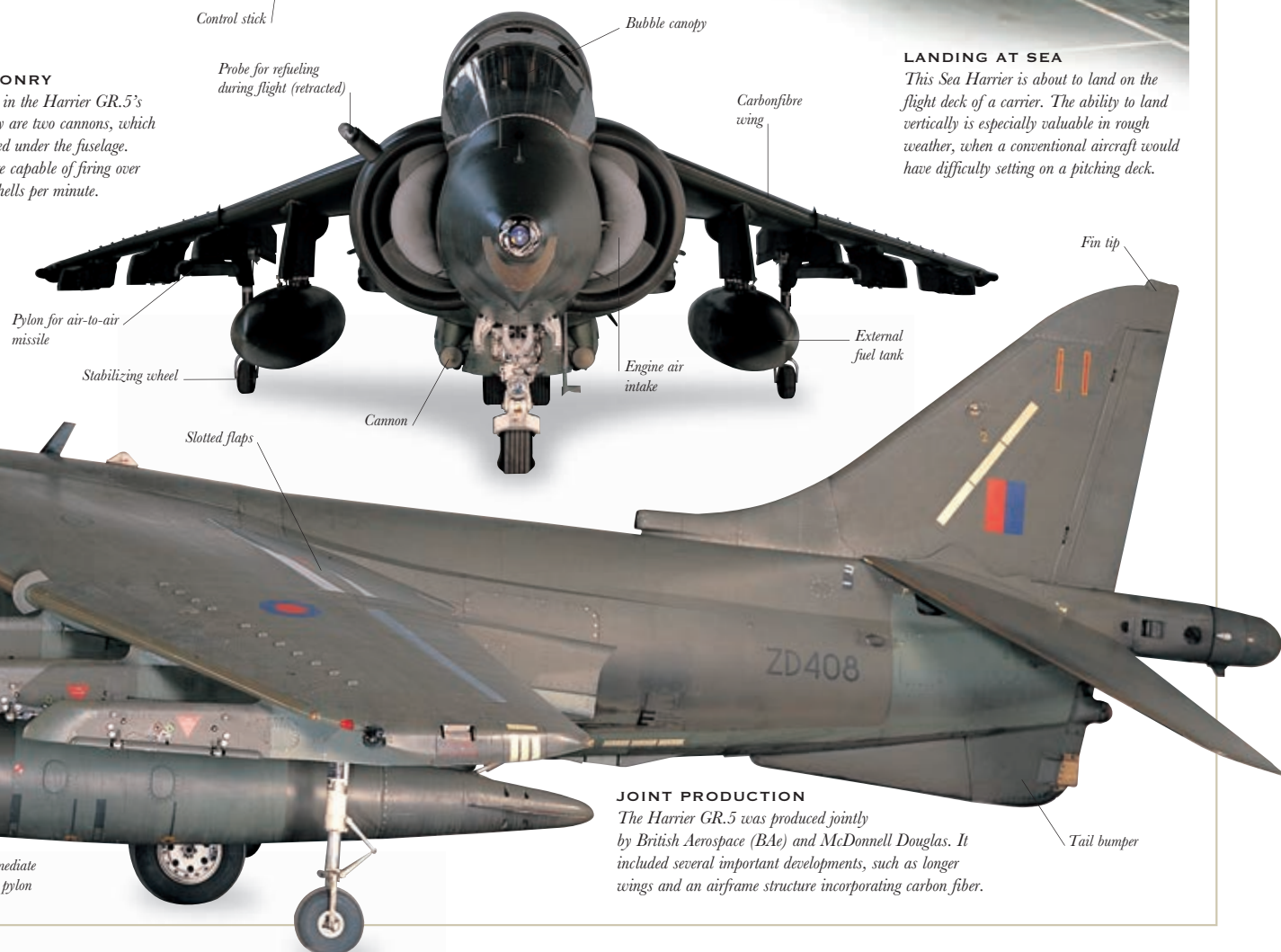


LANDING AT SEA

This Sea Harrier is about to land on the flight deck of a carrier. The ability to land vertically is especially valuable in rough weather, when a conventional aircraft would have difficulty setting on a pitching deck.

WEAPONRY

Included in the Harrier GR.5's weaponry are two cannons, which are housed under the fuselage. These are capable of firing over 3,500 shells per minute.



Probe for refueling during flight (retracted)

Bubble canopy

Carbonfibre wing

Pylon for air-to-air missile

Stabilizing wheel

Engine air intake

External fuel tank

Cannon

Slotted flaps

Fin tip

Intermediate stores pylon

JOINT PRODUCTION

The Harrier GR.5 was produced jointly by British Aerospace (BAe) and McDonnell Douglas. It included several important developments, such as longer wings and an airframe structure incorporating carbon fiber.

Tail bumper